Important Questions with Answers

Chapter 1: Understanding Social Science
Class 9 Social Science (NCERT) - Understanding Society: India and Beyond, Part 1

A. MCQs B. Fill in the Blanks C. True/False D. Match the Following E. Assertion-Reason F. Short Answer G. Long Answer

A. Multiple Choice Questions (1 mark each)

Q1. Social Science is best defined as:

(a) The study of the natural world
(b) The systematic study of human society
(c) The study of only past events
(d) The study of maps and globes

Answer: (b) The systematic study of human society

Q2. Which of these is NOT one of the four core disciplines of Social Science in Grades 9-10?

(a) Geography
(b) History
(c) Sociology
(d) Economics

Answer: (c) Sociology (it belongs to the wider Social Science family and will be developed in higher grades)

Q3. The idea of *Panchamahabhutas* refers to:

(a) Five great rulers
(b) Five great elements - earth, water, fire, air and space
(c) Five types of governments
(d) Five major rivers

Answer: (b) Five great elements - earth, water, fire, air and space

Q4. *Vasudhaiva kutumbakam* means:

(a) Wealth is power
(b) The world is one family
(c) Knowledge is supreme
(d) Duty comes first

Answer: (b) The world is one family

Q5. The *Arthashastra*, attributed to Kautilya, was composed about:

(a) 1,000 years ago
(b) 2,300 years ago
(c) 500 years ago
(d) 3,500 years ago

Answer: (b) 2,300 years ago

Q6. Information collected by actual observation or experimentation is called:

(a) Empirical evidence
(b) Genealogical record
(c) Oral tradition
(d) Epigraphic source

Answer: (a) Empirical evidence

Q7. Which source consists of texts or decrees inscribed on stone or metal plates?

(a) Numismatic
(b) Literary
(c) Epigraphic
(d) Genealogical

Answer: (c) Epigraphic source

Q8. The study of coins, currency and medals is called:

(a) Epigraphy
(b) Numismatics
(c) Archaeology
(d) Genealogy

Answer: (b) Numismatics

Q9. Which tool is commonly used by Geography?

(a) Carbon-14 dating
(b) Geographical Information System (GIS)
(c) Genealogical records
(d) Revenue documents

Answer: (b) Geographical Information System (GIS)

Q10. Which Indian system promotes grassroots democracy at the village level?

(a) Zamindari system
(b) Panchayati Raj
(c) Varna system
(d) Mansabdari system

Answer: (b) Panchayati Raj

Q11. Which discipline explores how societies produce, distribute and use resources?

(a) History
(b) Geography
(c) Political Science
(d) Economics

Answer: (d) Economics

Q12. The itihasa-purana tradition of Bharat is an old way of:

(a) Collecting taxes
(b) Preserving cultural memory through stories
(c) Making maps
(d) Governing villages

Answer: (b) Preserving cultural memory through stories

Q13. Which of these is an archaeological source?

(a) Travelogue
(b) Terracotta figurine from the Sindhu-Sarasvati Civilisation
(c) Revenue document
(d) Folk tale

Answer: (b) Terracotta figurine (material remains such as monuments, artefacts and sculptures are archaeological sources)

Q14. The School Bhuvan portal of NCERT helps students to:

(a) Learn typing
(b) Map their own village or city
(c) Take online exams
(d) Download novels

Answer: (b) Map their own village or city

B. Fill in the Blanks (1 mark each)

Q15. Social Science focuses on society, institutions, cultures and human _____.

Answer: interactions

Q16. Geography combines spatial perspectives (location) with _____ perspectives (change over time).

Answer: temporal

Q17. The four core disciplines in Grades 9-10 are Geography, History, _____ and Economics.

Answer: Political Science

Q18. Documents that trace family lineage by recording births, marriages and deaths are called _____ records.

Answer: genealogical

Q19. In Indian political thought, *dharma*, *artha* and _____ stand for moral duty, economic well-being and the duties of the ruler.

Answer: rajadharma

Q20. Modern historiography uses tools such as human genetics, archaeology and _____ dating to establish timelines.

Answer: carbon-14

Q21. The Prasanna Virupaksha Temple at Hampi has a _____ inscription of Emperor Krishnadeva Raya.

Answer: Kannada

Q22. A coin issued by King _____ in the 4th century CE is an example of a numismatic source.

Answer: Samudragupta

Q23. Colonial rule in India caused widespread poverty, recurrent _____ and decline of traditional industries.

Answer: famines

Q24. Economics aims at sustainable growth that meets present needs without harming the ability of _____ generations.

Answer: future

C. True or False (1 mark each)

Q25. Social Science explains only what happened, not why it happened.

Answer: False. It explains why events occur, how people live together, and how the past and present shape the world.

Q26. Physics, Chemistry and Biology study the natural world, whereas Social Science studies society.

Answer: True.

Q27. A single subject can fully explain a complex social situation such as a drought.

Answer: False. A drought affects environment, economy, politics and culture, so many disciplines are needed.

Q28. Geography studies only the physical features of the Earth.

Answer: False. It also studies human communities and how people interact with their environment.

Q29. Epigraphic sources include coins and medals.

Answer: False. Coins and medals are numismatic sources; epigraphic sources are inscriptions.

Q30. In Indian political thought, power was viewed as a responsibility and not merely a privilege.

Answer: True.

Q31. The Arthashastra deals with administration, taxation, army and welfare of the people.

Answer: True.

Q32. Social Science is mainly about memorising dates, maps and definitions.

Answer: False. It is about understanding people, places, society, culture and power.

Q33. Climate change, migration and new technologies make Social Science less important today.

Answer: False. Its importance grows as societies change rapidly.

Q34. Understanding diversity through Social Science builds respect and cooperation among communities.

Answer: True.

D. Match the Following (1 mark per pair)

Q35. Match the discipline with what it studies.

	Column A		Column B
1	Geography	A	Systems of governance, power and citizens' rights
2	History	B	Earth, its environments and people-environment relationships
3	Political Science	C	Use of limited resources to meet needs
4	Economics	D	Human past and change over time
5	Anthropology	E	Part of the wider Social Science family, studies human beings and cultures

Answer: 1-B; 2-D; 3-A; 4-C; 5-E

Q36. Match the source with its example.

	Column A		Column B
1	Literary source	A	Brahmi inscription on a Gupta pillar
2	Archaeological source	B	Terracotta figurine from Sindhu-Sarasvati Civilisation
3	Epigraphic source	C	Record of births, marriages and deaths
4	Numismatic source	D	Samudragupta's coin
5	Genealogical record	E	Tirukkural palm-leaf manuscript

Answer: 1-E; 2-B; 3-A; 4-D; 5-C

Q37. Match the term with its meaning.

	Column A		Column B
1	Panchamahabhutas	A	Foundational Indian text on politics and administration
2	Vasudhaiva kutumbakam	B	Local self-governance at the village level
3	Arthashastra	C	Five great elements explaining the natural world
4	Empirical evidence	D	Information from observation or experiment
5	Panchayati Raj	E	The world is one family

Answer: 1-C; 2-E; 3-A; 4-D; 5-B

E. Assertion-Reason Questions (1 mark each)

Options: *(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. (b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A. (c) A is true but R is false. (d) A is false but R is true.*

Q38. Assertion (A): Social Science is not a single subject.
Reason (R): It is a group of related disciplines, each focusing on a different aspect of human life.

Answer: (a)

Q39. Assertion (A): A drought cannot be understood by studying only one discipline.
Reason (R): A drought affects the environment, economy, politics and culture together.

Answer: (a)

Q40. Assertion (A): Numismatics helps historians study the economy and trade of a civilisation.
Reason (R): Coins show metal content, inscriptions and symbols.

Answer: (a)

Q41. Assertion (A): Political Science studies only formal institutions like the Parliament.
Reason (R): Power exists only in constitutions and governments.

Answer: (d) Both are false. Power also exists in social relationships, customs and ideas of legitimacy.

Q42. Assertion (A): Early Indian thinkers studied governance only after modern disciplines developed.
Reason (R): The Arthashastra examined administration and the economy about 2,300 years ago.

Answer: (d) A is false; R is true. Systematic thinking about governance existed long before modern disciplines.

Q43. Assertion (A): Social Science helps citizens take part responsibly in democracy.
Reason (R): It teaches how governments function and how decisions are made.

Answer: (a)

F. Short Answer Questions (2 to 3 marks each)

Q44. What is Social Science?

Answer: Social Science is the systematic study of human society. It explains why events occur, how people live together, how environments influence life, how governments function and economies operate, and how the past and present shape the world.

Q45. How does Social Science differ from Physics, Chemistry and Biology?

Answer: Physics, Chemistry and Biology study the natural world, whereas Social Science focuses on society, institutions, cultures and human interactions and why they happen.

Q46. Name the four core disciplines of Social Science in Grades 9-10 and state what each studies.

Answer: Geography studies the Earth, environments and people-environment relationships. History studies the human past and change over time. Political Science studies governance, power and citizens' rights and responsibilities. Economics studies how societies produce, distribute and use resources.

Q47. Why is Social Science called a group of disciplines?

Answer: Human society is complex and no single field can explain it fully. Different disciplines look at different aspects and together give a comprehensive, connected understanding.

Q48. What is meant by Panchamahabhutas?

Answer: It is an Indian philosophical idea that the natural world is made of five elements: earth (Prithvi), water (Apah), fire (Agni), air (Vayu) and space (Akasha). It is an early attempt to understand nature as an interconnected system.

Q49. What does the idea of *vasudhaiva kutumbakam* express?

Answer: It means 'the world is one family' and expresses the interconnectedness of human societies across regions and cultures, which is at the core of what Social Science studies.

Q50. What tools does Geography use?

Answer: Maps, globes, atlases, Geographical Information System (GIS), infographics and other instruments.

Q51. Define epigraphic and numismatic sources.

Answer: Epigraphic sources are texts, decrees or records inscribed on durable materials like stone or metal plates. Numismatic sources are coins, currency or medals which reveal economy, rulers, trade and culture.

Q52. What are archaeological sources? Give examples.

Answer: Material remains used to study the past, such as monuments, architectural structures, excavated sites, artefacts, sculptures and paintings. Example: a terracotta figurine from the Sindhu-Sarasvati Civilisation or a 12th century Vishnu sculpture.

Q53. How do social scientists develop explanations about society?

Answer: They observe people's lives, conduct interviews and surveys, examine documents and compare different times and places. By gathering information from multiple sources, they build explanations supported by evidence.

Q54. How did the Panchayati Raj system reflect ancient Indian political ideas?

Answer: It promotes local self-governance and public participation at the village level, showing how ancient ideas of power as responsibility continue to shape India's democratic practices.

Q55. Why should we study Social Science? (any three reasons)

Answer: It helps us understand the systems around us; builds respect for diversity and a sense of shared identity; prepares us for responsible citizenship; builds careful questioning and reasoning; and connects the past, present and future.

G. Long Answer Questions (5 marks each)

Q56. Explain how Social Science is useful in everyday life, with examples from the chapter.

Answer: Even simple daily activities depend on systems studied by Social Science.
1. The house you live in uses materials from many places; your food is harvested, processed, transported and sold by many people.
2. Roads are planned by public authorities, schools run on educational policies and electricity reaches homes through a vast network.
3. These rely on governance, economic production, social cooperation and the natural environment.
4. Questions such as why some regions flood, why communities speak different languages or why farming thrives in some places show that society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources and human choices.
Social Science helps us answer them through observation, evidence and logical reasoning.

Q57. Describe the contribution of ancient Indian traditions to understanding society.

Answer: India has a deep tradition of inquiry through discussion, questioning and reasoning.
1. **Panchamahabhutas** explained the world as an interconnected system of five elements and helped explain settlement patterns, occupations, food habits and health.
2. **Vasudhaiva kutumbakam** expressed the interdependence of societies.
3. The **Arthashastra** (Kautilya, about 2,300 years ago) examined administration, economic management, taxation and the duties of rulers, linking political authority with public welfare.
4. Politics was linked to *dharma*, *artha* and *rajadharma* in the Vedas, Upanishads, Puranas, Mahabharata and Shukraniti.
This shows that systematic thinking about society existed long before modern disciplines.

Q58. Describe History as a discipline. What types of sources do historians use?

Answer: History is the study of the human past, through which societies understand people's experiences, values and changes over time. The itihasa-purana tradition preserved cultural memory through stories. Modern historiography relies on empirical evidence and tools such as human genetics, carbon-14 dating and archaeology.
Sources include:
- **Literary:** travelogues, memoirs, correspondence, folklore and oral traditions, manuscripts such as the Samaveda and Tirukkural.
- **Genealogical records:** births, marriages and deaths.
- **Archaeological:** monuments, artefacts, sculptures and paintings.
- **Epigraphic:** inscriptions, e.g. Brahmi inscription of the Gupta period.
- **Numismatic:** coins, e.g. of Samudragupta and Jahangir.
- Revenue documents.

Q59. Explain how Geography, Political Science and Economics help us understand society.

Answer: Geography studies location and distribution of places and people and how humans interact with the environment. It combines spatial and temporal views and explains, for example, why India's long coastline made it a hub of global contact. It uses maps, globes, atlases and GIS.
Political Science studies governance: how power is distributed, decisions made and policies implemented. It covers constitutions, governments, social movements, nation building and foreign policy, and examples like the Panchayati Raj.
Economics studies how individuals and societies use limited resources. It looks at decisions of consumers, producers and governments and balances growth and stability, efficiency and fairness. It also traces India's economic history and challenges.

Q60. Why is a multi-disciplinary approach needed? Explain with the example of a drought.

Answer: Society is complex, so one discipline cannot explain it fully. A drought shows this:
- Environment: it damages crops.
- Economy: it reduces farmers' incomes.
- Politics: government relief measures are needed.
- Society and culture: people migrate to cities and use traditional ways of coping with scarcity.

Geography, Economics, Political Science and History each reveal one part, and together they give a holistic understanding.

Q61. Discuss the importance and future of Social Science.

Answer: Importance: it explains how systems developed and affect different groups; explains diversity as an outcome of geographical, historical, cultural and economic factors; builds respect, cooperation and a sense of belonging; prepares citizens for democratic life; and connects past, present and future.
Future: new technologies, expanding cities, environmental concerns, migration and global connections are reshaping life. Social Science will help address climate change, sustainable development, social harmony and equitable use of resources, guide responsible use of technology, and help citizens shape society while strengthening national unity and cultural roots.